FinTech Company Case

Report and Recorded Presentation Brief

Team	Use your machine-learning investment assignment team (up to three students).
Written report	10% of the course grade; one PDF, no more than 10 pages in total, including the cover, figures, tables, references, and any appendix.
Recorded video	20% of the course grade; record using Zoom. No more than 10 minutes, with at least two minutes of analysis presented by each member.
Due date	Both components are due by **12:00 noon on 29 November 2026**.
Submission	One member uploads the report PDF to Canvas. On the **first page**, include the Zoom recording link and all members' names and student IDs. **Do not set a password for the recording.** Use the company and submitter's student ID as the filename. No video upload or in-person presentation is required.

Main question: How does this business use financial technology to serve customers, earn revenue or reduce costs, and sustain its business model?

Choosing a case

Study a FinTech company, or a product or platform through which a traditional financial institution uses FinTech: for example, a payment company's merchant services, a bank's cross-border payment platform, or an insurer's digital claims service. Focus on one business. Classroom cases and unsuccessful businesses are eligible; use additional evidence to develop your own analysis.

Report framework

1. **Customers and financial need.** Define the business, market, and period studied. Who uses the service, what problem does it address, and how was that problem handled before?
2. **Service and technology.** Explain how the service works, the roles of key partners, and what the technology changes. Focus on business use rather than technical design.
3. **Business model.** Explain revenue, costs, and what determines profitability. For an internal platform, explain cost savings or its contribution to the wider business. Compare it with a competitor or traditional service.
4. **Evidence and assessment.** Assess performance, main risks, and relevant regulation using dated evidence. Explain whether the business model can succeed, or why it failed.

Hints for your analysis

- **Follow the money.** Who uses the service, and who pays? Is revenue earned per transaction, through subscriptions, or elsewhere in the business? Users and paying customers may differ. What are the main costs?
- **Separate volume, revenue, and profit.** For example, $1 million of payments at a 0.5% fee generates $5,000 of fee revenue, before processing, customer acquisition, and operating costs. These are hypothetical figures, not company data.
- **Start with public evidence.** Look at annual reports, product and pricing pages, regulatory disclosures, and reliable news. If product-level profit is unavailable, use pricing, adoption, and cost information to discuss what determines profitability. Label assumptions and estimates.

Ask yourself: without this technology, how would the same task be done, and what does this business improve? These are prompts, not extra questions. Diagrams and calculations are optional; coding is not required.

Recorded presentation

Present your analysis, evidence, and conclusion with readable slides and clear audio. Choose your own order and timing; identify each speaker. Check that the instructor and TAs can play the recording, and keep it accessible until grading is complete.

Evidence and assessment standards

- Cite sources for factual claims, data, and borrowed visuals. Use dated company disclosures and independent sources; distinguish their claims from your team's conclusions. Label dates and units on exhibits.
- The report is assessed on business-model analysis, evidence, comparison, risks, and reasoned conclusions. The video is assessed on the quality and clarity of analysis, evidence and visuals, and each member's contribution.
- Briefly disclose how you used generative AI, if applicable, and check its claims, sources, and calculations before submission.

Suggested Companies

Hong Kong FinTech Week 2026

These are some companies I found interesting while attending Hong Kong FinTech Week this week. I recommend them as possible starting points for your case study. **You are welcome to choose other companies.** The research directions below are suggestions, not additional requirements. For a large group, focus on one product or business. Click a company name for a source to get started.

Payments and cross-border services

Payment Asia. Merchant payment services: why do merchants pay a gateway to connect different payment methods?

Tencent. TenPay Global: cross-border merchant collections, currency conversion, and the role of banking partners.

XTransfer. Payments for smaller exporters: compare payment fees and foreign-exchange costs with a bank transfer.

PhotonPay. Multi-currency business accounts: how does a merchant collect sales proceeds and pay overseas suppliers?

Digital lending and business finance

FundPark. E-commerce financing: how can inventory, sales, and receivables data support a lending decision?

WeBank. Weiyedai small-business loans: compare online credit assessment with conventional business lending.

Du Xiaoman. Youqianhua: distinguish the credit platform from its lending partners, including who funds loans and bears losses.

Stablecoins and business payments

Circle. USDC: explain reserve income, distribution costs, and how interest rates affect the issuer's business.

Ripple. Ripple Payments: compare one cross-border payment use case with correspondent banking.

Reap. Business cards or bill payments: follow how fiat or stablecoins fund payments, and examine fees and collateral.

Tokenised funds and securities

ChinaAMC HK. A tokenised money market fund: what changes in ownership records, access, and redemption compared with a conventional fund?

Franklin Templeton. Benji and the OnChain U.S. Government Money Fund: how does a token represent a fund share?

HSBC. Orion: use a digital bond issuance to examine changes in issuance and settlement, and potential cost savings.

Suggested Companies continued

Digital asset trading and custody

HashKey. HashKey Exchange in the HKSAR market: trading fees, customer asset arrangements, and compliance costs.

Binance. Spot trading in one market: how do trading volume, fees, and liquidity affect the exchange's business?

BitGo. Institutional custody: why would an institution pay a custodian rather than manage its own private keys?

Digital brokerage and wealth management

Huatai Securities. AI ZhangLe: how could an AI-assisted investment service support customer acquisition, retention, or staff productivity?

Longbridge. Digital brokerage in the HKSAR market: how can a broker earn income while advertising zero commission?

Insurance technology

AIA. AIA Vitality: how could activity tracking and rewards affect customer behaviour and the insurance business?

FWD. Digital claims in one market: examine processing costs, customer service, and the continuing role of human review.

Igloo. Insurance sold at e-commerce checkout: distinguish the technology provider, marketplace, and risk-bearing insurer.

Compliance technology and digital identity

FCC Analytics. Bank transaction monitoring: compare analytics-based alerts with a rule-based system, including false alarms and investigation costs.

Regula. Identity verification for account opening: compare automated checks with manual review in terms of cost and fraud detection.

Fill Easy. GovVerify or CorpVerify: why would a financial institution buy identity or company-data services rather than build its own connections?

Finding evidence. Start with the linked product pages and disclosures, then compare company claims with independent evidence. Check the date and market covered by each source. Pricing and customer cases can be useful when a private company does not disclose product-level profit.